

8 Time Machine & Boot Camp

This chapter deals with two important features of Mac OS – Time Machine, and Boot Camp. While Time Machine ensures the data safety of your computer by acting as a backup utility (a more advanced and powerful version of system restore in Windows), Boot Camp allows you to use multiple operating systems (mainly Windows), on your Mac.

8.1 Time Machine

Apple has gone out of its way to make this utility live up to its name. Introduced along with the 10.5 “Leopard” release of Mac OS X, everything from the name, interface to the working methodology of this handy little application is Time Machine themed. While the programme, like many other backup utilities stores incremental backups of all files on the computer (or a part, which you can choose), the interface, using Apple’s Core Animation API, looks like a time tunnel, with stars and galaxies in the background, to give you a true feel of time travel. Let us take a look at how it works.

By default, the Time Machine can be accessed from the dock. However, if you have disabled this, you may access it from system preferences or using finder. Once the Time Machine menu opens, the first step to follow is to turn it on. To do so, click on the Time Machine Slider on the bottom left corner of the menu, so that it slides to the on position. You will be asked to set up time machine.

Once you click on the “Set up Time Machine” button, you will face a window wherein you may click to choose your backup location. In the list that follows this click, you may choose one of your hard disk partitions, an external drive that has been plugged in (which will automatically be added to this menu) or, the coolest of all, choose to set up a Time Capsule.

8.1.1 Time Capsule

The Time Capsule is a network storage device cum gateway router marketed by Apple starting 2008. Optimised for working with Time Machine, the Time Capsule is today available in two sizes, 1 TB and 2 TB. The device works on the Apple AirPort technology (the Mac version of Wi-Fi) and supports 802.11n connectivity with downward compatibility. The device is multi band (allowing multiple computers to access it at once), can be personalized, and expanded in memory using an external hard disk connected through its USB port. Apart from being a Backup tool, the Time Capsule is also an AirPort